

section of the site. If you are skilled enough in python then you can also write your plugin and share it with the rest of the community.

Blender being an open source software, has a large community of developers and users on the internet with a number of dedicated forums to not only help you get started but also get you through any wall you hit.

Another very important factor is the file size. The Blender setup file is 80 MB in size while After effects setup file is more than 2GB in size, making Blender very convenient to carry around with you or download off the net in a jiffy.

Cons: What it cannot do

There's only so much Blender can do. There are a number of things where Blender falls behind After Effects. To start with, Blender is considerably difficult to get a hang of than After Effects. Though there are a number of tutorials available online, Blender has a steep learning curve especially if it is your first time using a 3D modelling/ video compositing software.

No doubt the node based approach helps you when working on complex projects, but still the layer based approach is easier for simpler stuff like editing and adding effects to a home videos which is all that a normal user would like to do.

After Effects also wins in compositing. There are some things where the Blender compositor is easier to work with, but you can still achieve the same things, albeit with a little difficulty, in After Effects, but there are a number of things which After Effects can do but Blender simply can't.

After Effects is also easier and faster to use for motion graphics animation when compared to Blender.

	After Effects	Blender
Video Input formats supported	MPEG, OGG, MOV, AVI	AAF, CAM, M4V, MPEG-2, AVI
Video Output formats supported	3GP, FLV, M4V, MPEG-2	AVI, MPEG, MPEG-4, MOV
Platform supported	Mac, Windows	Linux, Mac, Windows, Solaris, Irix

Taking it out for a spin/Comparison

For the final comparison we decided to pit both the software head on, and took them out for a spin and tried doing something similar on both of them. We tried making a 3D text disappear into smoke in both the software.

The first thing you see in Blender's 3D workspace is a cube sitting right in the center. Move the cube away from the workspace and add text which